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THE CLOSING COACH

(UK CLOSERS LTD)

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THIS MANUAL BELONGS TO :

IF FOUND PLEASE RETURN TO :

WELCOME

Firstly, a huge welcome on board from myself and the team!

We're excited to help you start moving the needle on your close rate, without the need for cringey pressure tactics, rigid scripts OR pressure selling.

I created this book with you in mind as I personally find a written guide useful during my calls, so I hope you find this to be your new sales "can't live without".

You'll find 4 key sections within this guide :

Firstly your set up and introduction, this will walk you through exactly HOW to customise and use the templated pages for your sales calls.

Secondly, the bank of templated pages, you'll note that there are a LOT of these, the reason being, I want this guide to last you through many sales conversations

Thirdly a section of useful question cheat sheets. We've aligned these by category for you to support in really understanding how to navigate and apply intelligent questioning for your calls.

Lastly we never want to rely on these, the aim is to AVOID them, but inevitably, you will hit objections. We've created an Objections lifeline to help you quickly and smoothly handle the most common objections.

HOW TO USE

I have designed this guide to be applicable to as many businesses as possible meaning some of this we will need use our coaching calls to support in customise the sections to get the most out of the guide.

I've added an example on the next page so that you can see how I'd set a page up then on the following page a "completed" page of notes so you can see what you're aiming for!

For your calls you're going to be focusing on

1, Making sure you have at LEAST 10mins before your call to set up your pages correctly

2, Multitasking through each area of this guide. We can guide our lead but cannot control where their mind will go based on information they tell us. So naturally, you won't complete the pages in a strict order.

3, Ensuring you don't move to closing, pricing or next steps questions until you have the information we need on this guide. Remember to follow the call framework to guide you with this.

4, Taking your time and ensuring you remain flexible throughout the call based on what you learn from the client.

CLIENT NAME

COMPANY NAME : WHAT DO THEY DO?

PRE APPOINTMENT INFO

PREPARED QUESTIONS

KEY ANSWER INFO

NEW QUESTIONS

KEY ANSWER INFO

FINANCIALS

PRESENT

WHAT DOES THIS MEAN

FUTURE

WHAT WOULD THAT MEAN

OBJECTION SET UP

SECURE

☐

☐

☐

PROBLEM/SOLUTION BUILD

KEY PAINS/PROBLEMS

FINANCIAL

SIMPLICITY

KEY RISKS IF NO CHANGE

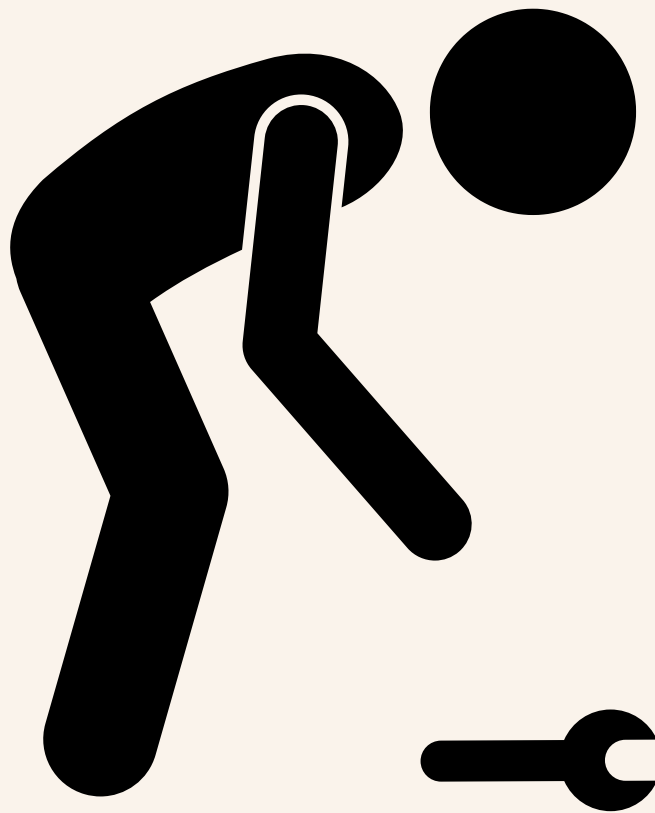
KEY GOALS/DESIRES

OPPORTUNITIES [YOUR WORDS]

YOUR RECCOMENDED SOLUTION

ONCE COMPLETE START PLAYBACK & SOLUTION

“WE DON’T WALK PAST A
STATEMENT, WE STOP AND
PICK IT UP”



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QUESTION FUNNELING

It's incredibly important when it comes to questions, to remember that the questions we ask must be "intelligent". In other words, questions with a purpose.

Some things to help you stay in the right frame of mind with this :

Assumptions make an "Ass out of U and ME".

You do not need appear to know about your leads industry or position.

Your job is to remain truly curious and interested in what the lead has to say.

Your job is not to FORCE the sale, your job is to ask the right questions and play the right character, the close will come with this.

You have permission to take your time, with questions, with answers, with understanding what your client is trying to explain.

If you do not have your own back by preparing properly, you will prepare yourself to fail.

QUESTION FUNNELING

A question funnel should act as a tool to ensure you do not assume pains, needs or wants.

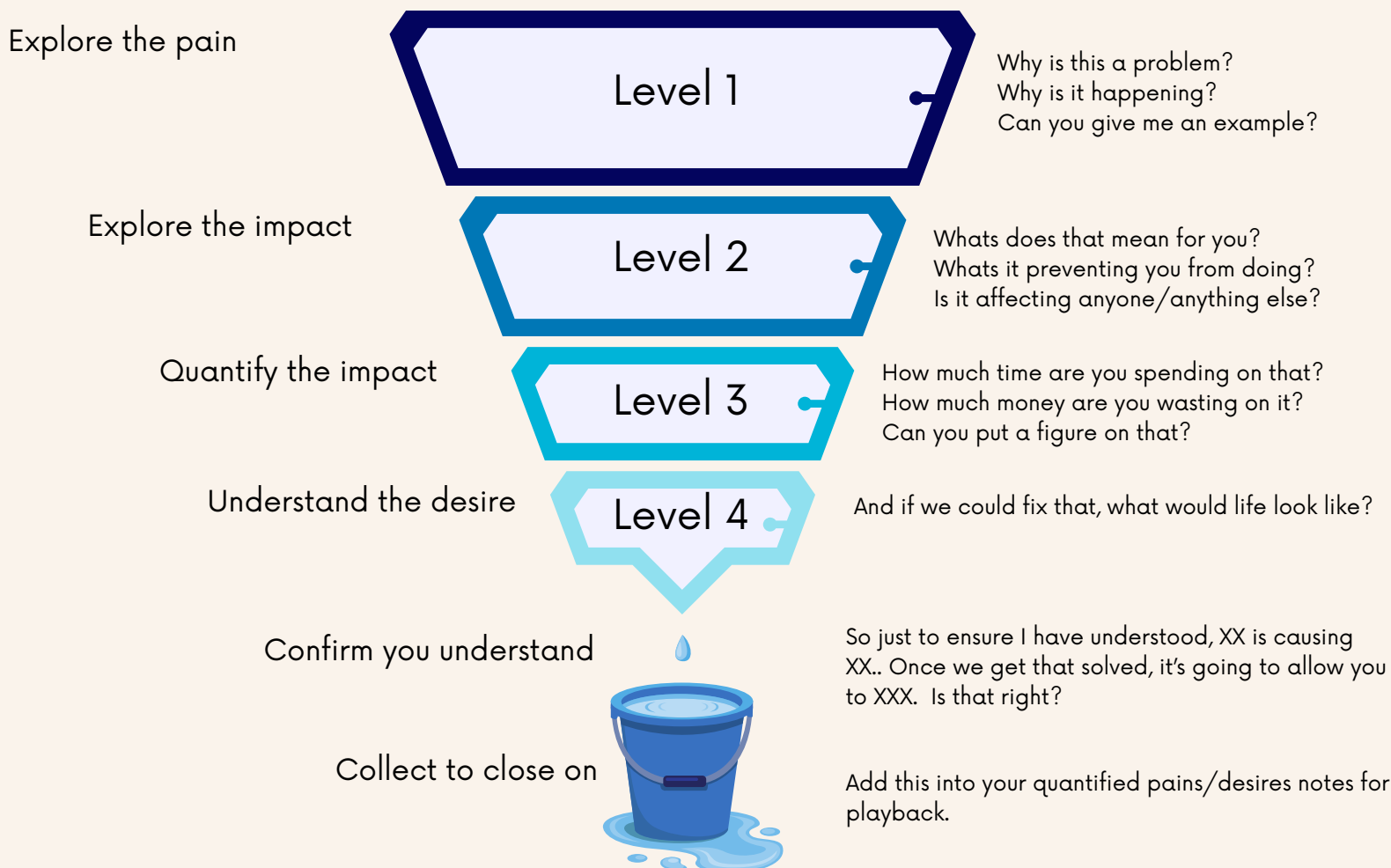
It will also allow you to play back these challenges in EXACTLY the same language as the client.

We typically ask these questions after the lead has “poured” so please don’t interrupt this flow until your lead has finished.

We then want to ask permission to ask these probing questions, then we can explore the funnel.

To use this in a simple framework, we don’t want to move on from a subject unless

1. You can quantify or measure it
2. You understand the emotional or professional impact of it
3. You could confidently explain the above to someone else



QUESTION FUNNELING EXAMPLES

CALL OPENING

I've had a look over the notes you left for us so I understand a little about your business, but the best place to start is from the top. So _____ tell me a bit more about _____ and whats going on with _____?

I suppose introducing my role is a good start hey! I'm _____ and my job is to _____ so in order for me to do that, the best place is actually to start with you! I'm interested to hear a little bit more about _____ whats going on?

CLARIFICATION

Anything else to add?

Theres never enough info you could tell us, is there anything else you feel might be relevant?

Anything else you feel would help me to know?

PERMISSION

Okay great, I mean thank you for the high level overview, I've been taking notes. So the way that I typically like to help is actually be a bit nosey so I can learn more about your situation and see if we can actually help you. Do I have permission to dive in with a few probing questions for the next 5-10mins?

Ready to be in the hot seat?

TOP OF QUESTION FUNNEL

**** These top of funnel questions will be a mix of your Pre build core questions and your notes from the lead "pour".

When you said _____ what did you mean by that?

Can you tell me more about _____?

Why is _____ causing such a challenge?

Why do you want _____?

Why are you personally tasked with _____?

What would _____ allow you to do?

OBJECTION SET UP

The goal with objection set up is to set you up with the tools to “pre” handle objections before they become closing objections.

We'll work with you on your coaching calls to be able to identify the key objections for your product or service, and how to pre handle and set yourself up for a close.

Objection	The Truth	Goals	Examples
“It’s too expensive”	We’ve failed to align the value of our solution to the need of the lead . or We’ve failed to select the right financial solution for the client.	To identify the correct investment level for this client by ensuring we understand how much they have available and how much the solution will bring them in value.	We can use the financials section to calculate affordability and financial goals or outcome We can use question funnelling to identify the personal value to the lead.
“I need to think about it” or “I need to speak to my partner”	This objection often masks MANY different objections (often financial or trust) It can also mean : We’ve failed to identify their decision making process/authority	To ensure we have answered all of the clients questions, we have build trust through proof, we’ve aligned our closing process with their decision making criteria.	Explore what the lead hasn’t found yet that has stopped them moving on a solution. Identify a decision criteria that is important to them and tell a story or show proof to talk to that
“I’m not sure we need it”	We’ve failed to correctly identify what this lead needs in the service or solution. or We may have spoken to much about an irrelevant subject for the lead.	We want to listen closely and avoid any assumptions about this lead needs and wants We want to ensure we cover only relevant and poignant topics for the lead.	We could use “so that I’m not at risk of assuming...” questions We should use affirmative questions throughout any presentation to ensure we’re on the right track
“Can you send me a proposal”	We’ve failed to give them space on the call to process a decision or We’ve not been able to clearly translate the benefits in line with their need or We’ve failed to understand the decision making process/authority	We need to clarify with the lead the exact needs and the reasons beyond those. We need to ensure we allow for thought breaks and “self closing”. We want to know if this lead has authority	We can use question funnelling to identify the surface level need and the want beyond that. We should actively “look” for thinking signs from our lead, allow pauses and slow down our conversation pace. We should confirm the lead is the decision maker so that we can decide to close or extend.

OBJECTION HANDLING

Inevitably, objections will arise on some of your sales calls even if you've done your very best to "pre handle" them!

You can use this sheet to help you with understanding the real reason behind the objection and getting back into the conversation.

****It's important to note that there are both 1) Stall objections 2) Real objections. If this cheat sheet doesn't get you back into the conversation, consider setting next steps and formulating a close plan with your lead to work with any real objections.**

Before delivering an objection handle, it's really important to character shift, this might be a pause, looking confused, changing your posture or lowering your tone of voice

All of the objections below are going to give you the ability to handle the initial objection with the intention to move forward BUT if you do indeed get a push back on those handles, there is one key line to remember in all cases.

-----, Can I be really candid with you?

Typically when a ----- says something like this, it's usually because I've missed something or we haven't covered something you were hoping to talk about...

Be really honest with me, what is it?

Use this as a default to get back into the conversation.



OBJECTION HANDLING

IT'S TOO EXPENSIVE

If you don't believe this is a real objection	...Can I be really candid with you? [Lead responds] Often it's easy to look at ____ as a "cost", but actually it's usually because we're looking at things from a current state of play. Fast forward ____months down the line when you've achieved _____ we'd look at this as an "investment"? Would you feel it was expensive at that point? [Lead responds] [**they may move forward, if not, dig for more pain below] Okay, so if thats the case, I don't understand why we're waiting?
If you don't believe this is a real objection	...____[lead name]_, I recognise that it's easy for me to feel calm and confident about the investment when we can see the results [quality] on our side, but when you've had ____[insert objection/worry] _ I can understand a hesitation... I suppose, If money wasn't involved, lets say this was free... what would you do? [lead responds] Okay, but why, what do you think it'd do for you? [lead responds] Okay understood, so if it isn't a confidence challenge, is it that finances aren't physically in the bank or is it something else? [if they say the money isn't there you could say...] Thank you for being so open with me, now I understand a bit more about where you are, in that case, How do we work together to make the financials work for you? What would allow you to take action today? [you could then take a deposit/secure action]
If you believe it's a real objection	_____ so that I can help properly, do you mind if I ask you a bit of a personal question? [Lead responds] Is it that finances aren't physically in the bank or is it something else? [Lead responds] Okay thank you for being so open with me. In that case, so I can see how I can best help you, what budget had you agreed upon before you walked into this conversation with me? [Lead responds] [at this point you need to decide if you have a different package, a payment plan, to take a deposit or if they're not a good fit financially]

OBJECTION HANDLING

I NEED TO THINK ABOUT IT

With this objection it's important to change your posture tone and body language.

We need to acknowledge that if this arises we've missed something in the conversation so we need to look visibly "concerned" that we haven't helped them the way we help everyone else.

_____ I'm so sorry.

Usually when I hear this from _____ it usually means that I've not done my job properly and that I've either missed something or we've not spoken about something you were hoping to find.

Be really honest with me, what is it?

"It's too expensive"	Move to "it's too expensive" page
"I'm just not sure about XXX"	You're back in the conversation! FIRST Clarify "Okay thank you for being so candid with me, was there anything else or was that the only thing?" Explore objection handling that topic through outcomes, deliverables, features and benefits.
"I was really hoping that it would do/have XXXXXX"	You're back in the conversation! FIRST Clarify "Okay thank you for being so candid with me, was there anything else?" Explore objection handling that topic through outcomes, deliverables, features and benefits.

OBJECTION HANDLING

I NEED TO SPEAK TO MY PARTNER

With this objection it's important to change your posture tone and body language. We need to look visibly "concerned" that we haven't helped them the way we help everyone else.

_____ I'm so sorry.

Usually when I hear this from _____ it usually means that I've not done my job properly and that I've either missed something or we've not spoken about something you were hoping to find.

Be really honest with me, what is it?

**"No theres
nothing I just
don't make a
decision
without my
partner"**

"Okay understood, so if I'm understanding correctly, you're confident that the (product/service) is going to achieve _____ and it's accessible for you in terms of investment is that right?"

(Lead responds)

Okay...so what if you had this conversation and your partner says no? What would you do then?

(Lead responds, usually responds a little confused)

Is your partner aware that you want to achieve _____?

(Lead responds)

How do you feel it would benefit them too?

(pause)

_____ I suppose usually why I'm hesitating for you here...is that something doesn't seem to make sense here.

Usually if I hear that someones partner is behind the mission/goal but the decision maker still wants to speak to them, it's usually a hesitation or a stall.

But the reason I'm concerned is we've spoken about _____ and _____ and _____ being such a challenge right now,

If I don't help you make a decision today, are we going to be stuck in the cycle?

(Lead thinks, may or may not open up)

(Move to either close, building their confidence or REAL objection)

**"It's too
expensive"**

Move to "it's too expensive" page

**"I'm just not
sure about
XXX"**

You're back in the conversation!

FIRST

**"I was really
hoping that
it would
do/have
XXXXXX"**

Clarify

"Okay thank you for being so candid with me, was there anything else or was that the only thing?"

Explore objection handling that topic through outcomes, deliverables, features and benefits.

OBJECTION HANDLING

I'M NOT SURE WE NEED IT

With this objection we have missed our target in the set up.

When this occurs we have aligned the product/service to something that isn't important to this client.

We need to get back into the conversation to fix this.

_____ I'm so sorry.

Usually if ever I hear this it means I've not done my job properly in understanding your needs as a _____.

So that I can try to put that right, do you mind if we just circle back fro a minute?

I understood your challenges/needs as _____, _____, _____

Was there anything missing from this list that we should add in?

[lead responds]

[If they add something in, you need to explore that, the impact, what they have in place and what they need]

Okay great, so your challenges/needs are _____, _____, _____

And thats causing _____, _____, _____.

So I can really understand, what do you already have in place thats makes you feel like you don't need this?

"We don't have anything in place"	Okay... now I hear this from _____ it usually means that I've either missed something or we've not spoken about something you were hoping to find. Be really honest with me, what is it?
"We don't have anything in place I'm just not sure how your product can help"	You're back in the conversation! FIRST Clarify "Okay understood! Would you mind sharing where you feel the missing dots are so I can try to help? Explore objection handling that topic by explaining more concisely.
It's actually too expensive	Move to it's to expensive page

OBJECTION HANDLING

CAN YOU SEND ME A PROPOSAL

This is either a staller OR you have miss-diagnosed their buying decision and authority

If you're confident that they're the decision maker	Oh, sure, but, can I just ask actually what for? (Lead thinks and moves past their own objection)
If you're confident that they're the decision maker	Oh, sure, but, can I just ask actually what for? (Lead responds that they need it so that they can understand or look over _____) Well why don't we go ahead and do that now so that I can answer any questions (jump into the specific topic)
If they might not	Oh, sure, but, can I just ask actually what for? (Lead responds that they not the decision maker and they need to get sign off from _____) Okay sure, well rather than send a proposal as we tend to find it doesn't bring as much colour to the conversation, how do we get them on a call? (lead responds, book in the slot) So that I can help you get the best outcome from that conversation, what does _____ care about the most when it comes to _____. (lead responds) And do you have any concerns as to why they'd say no? (lead responds) And how do they typically make a decision? Driven by what? (lead responds) Okay great, I'd suggest we follow this agenda _____ with the intention to move forward on the call. How do we set those expectations with _____. (lead responds.) Great, and lastly, how do we make sure that _____ turns up to the session if I'm holding another 60mins in my diary for you? (Lead responds)

NOTES